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Online complaint redressal

Turning to problem resolution online

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Jessica bought a brand new notebook from her first income. But her excitement was dulled by her laptop's constant hanging problem. Visiting service centres and emailing the company was futile. As last resort, she posted her complaint on a popular social network. Like-minded complainants raised similar issues about the product. Within two days, the company's head office deputed a senior officer to resolve her complaint.

Besides MNCs, even government instrumentalities like Delhi Police, Municipal Corporation of Delhi and many other

organisations have their pages on networking web sites to directly reach out to the public. This platform keeps consumers aware about scams and product safety issues besides other things. Supplement information such as upcoming events, campaigns, alerts and news about the product and/or brand can be of immense help in taking informed decisions.

Successful social media interactions between companies/brands and consumers translate into profitable propositions for both, the consumer and the brand. For individuals, however, social

media is more about expression than connection. Likewise, the consumer is in a better position to raise his voice against the multinationals. Consumer's one online post can shake a company's brand reputation and credibility in a few minutes. If not cause damage, it can certainly raise doubts in the minds of many prospective consumers. The online complaint redressal system is cheap and the ability to post on it twice, thrice and many more times makes the forum even more potent. Companies are similarly aware of the potential of networking tools; therefore, they can't risk being casual about it.

Today's consumer is interactive, vocal and expects a responsive brand to listen to him. The Ministry of Consumer Affairs should take heed to ensure happier, satisfied customers. **d**

COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

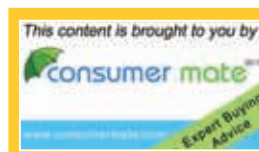
Dysfunctional Micromax X600 buttons since past 3 months

Question: I purchased a Micromax X600 Gravity dual SIM mobile on 20th Oct 2010. After a few months, the red button of the mobile stopped working. I handed over the mobile to Micro Care Service Centre in Doltanganj on 14th April 2011. Even after 45 days, neither has my mobile been repaired nor did they give me another mobile.

Contacted By: Ragini Mishra

Answer By Consumermate:

Dear Consumer,
We're in receipt of numerous complaints regarding the same company products. The company in no circumstances can hold you waiting like this for your product duly repaired. If they don't respond in a week, write them a registered letter in the shape of a legal demand notice containing all the problems in detail. You can hold responsible the company and the service centre for misappropriating your property. You can warn them about your filing a police complaint for criminally misappropriating your property/product. In case, they don't come up with a solution, go ahead with filing consumer complaints in the district forum. I hope at the stage of notice itself they will sort out things. Keep all the communication handy for all the future actions.



We can help!

If you're facing a problem with your purchase, write to us at help@consumermate.com

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